Medical Secretaries

Referral intake and correspondence

Check referral pack
against the document
checklist

Validate supporting
documents and flag
missing items

Is the referral
pack complete?

Referral to
Consultant

Referral awaiting
clinical decision

Request the
missing
information

Waiting for the
missing
information

Information
received

No response after
14 days

Referral closed
- information not
received

Referral outcome
returned by the
Consultant

Record the decision and

notify the referring
organisation
Outcome to the
referrer

Outcome
recorded and
referrer informed

Clinic letter
approved by the
Consultant

Check and process the
approved clinic letter

Does the letter
need a clinical
correction?

Return the letter
to the Consultant

Returned for
amendment

Letter filed with
distribution
evidence

Dispatch the clinic letter

Unreadable Incomplete

All expected
documents
present

Something is
missing

Suspected clinical
error

Administrative
checks passed

External Correspondence Service

Letter production and dispatch

Letter received for
distribution

Print and dispatch the
letter

Return the
dispatch result

Dispatch result
returned

External Payment Service Provider

Card transactions and refunds

Secure payment
request received

Process the card

transaction and report
the outcome
Return the
payment status
and reference

Payment result
returned

Finance

Team

Funding, charges and payments Refunds, impact and enquiries

Determine the funding
route and record the

approval

Record the funding
decision for audit

Which funding
route applies?

Record the funding
approval
Return the
funding decision

Funding decision
returned

Work out the charge
payable

Price the treatment

manually

Chase the insurer for pre-
authorisation

Payment taken
without
confirmation

Investigate the
unconfirmed payment

Was the money
actually taken?

Record the payment
against the account

Investigation
closed

Investigation
closed

Refund decision
required

Decide whether a refund
is due

Record the refund
decision for audit

What did Finance
decide?

Prepare the approved
refund

Send the refund to the

payment provider

Did the provider
accept the
refund?

Record the refund

against the patient
account
Refund recorded

Tell the patient
the refund is
delayed

Refund still with
the provider

Record that no refund is
due

Tell the patient no
refund is due

No refund
- decision record
ed

Financial impact
review requested

Review the financial

impact of the treatment
change
What does the
change require?

Record the
financial outcome

Financial impact
resolved

Payment enquiry

Answer the payment or
funding enquiry

Enquiry answered Enquiry answered

Funding check
requested

Pricing failed

Rejected

Approved or
exempt

Patient pays

Pre-authorisation
outstanding

Payment located

Nothing was
taken

Refund approved

No refund due

Refunded

Not accepted yet

Charge or refund
No change to the to adjust
account

External

Treatment, Laboratory and Imaging

Services
Treatment and diagnostic

capacity

Capacity check
requested by the
booking team

Check treatment,
laboratory and imaging
capacity
Return what is
available and
when

Capacity returned

Treatment and Chemotherapy Bookings

Team

Treatment booking and funding Cycles and treatment changes

Booking request
received

Check the request is
complete and authorised

Return the
request to the
clinical team

Request returned
for authorisation

Ask Finance how
this treatment is
funded

Waiting on the
funding decision

Funding decision
received

Funding decision
overdue

Who is paying for
this treatment?

Prepare the secure
payment request

Take the payment
through the payment
provider
What did the
provider report?

Booking
prerequisites
satisfied

Check the charge has not
already been taken

Decide how to handle the

failed payment

Try again or hand
it over?

Record the next payment
attempt
Leave the
payment with the
Finance Team

Payment
unresolved
- booking not con
firmed

Mark the
transaction for
investigation

Ask a clinician
about proceeding
anyway

Urgency decision
returned

May treatment go
ahead without
confirmed
payment?

Chase the outstanding
funding approval

Has the approval
come through?

Record the
funding delay

Booking held
pending funding
approval

Create the provisional
appointment series

Check external treatment

and diagnostic capacity

Is everything
available?

Confirm the treatment

appointments
Treatment
schedule
confirmed

Tell the patient
and start the clinic
letter

Clinic letter
requested

Send the treatment
confirmation letter

Both notifications
issued

Schedule
confirmed

Booking pending Retry external
capacity

Next
chemotherapy
cycle authorised

Schedule the next cycle Look for a slot for the

next cycle

Was a cycle slot
found?

Next cycle booked Are there further
cycles in this
course?

Next cycle booked
and review
requested

Course of
treatment
complete

Flag the capacity
problem

Cycle booking
held

Cycle delayed on
clinical grounds

Record the delay and re-
plan the cycle

Tell the pathway
team and the
patient

Delay recorded

Treatment plan
change requested

Treatment change
authorised

Apply the treatment
change to the schedule

Does the change
affect money
already handled?

Refer the
financial impact
to Finance

Treatment change
applied

Review the treatment

change request

Send the change
for clinical
authorisation

Change
forwarded for
authorisation

Release the provisional
appointment series

Release the provisional
cycle booking

Undo the
provisional series

Undo the
provisional cycle
slot

Record another capacity
attempt

Have we tried
long enough?

Tell the pathway
team the booking
was released

Retry the whole
booking later

Flag the funding
delay to the
pathway team

Payment
unresolved
- booking not con
firmed
- May treatment
go ahead without
confirmed payme

Treatment change
applied
- Refer the financ
ial impact to
Finance

Not authorised

Provider down No confirmation

Unavailable

No capacity

Series committed

Cycle slot
committed

Approval now in
place

Patient pays

Hospital, insurer
or exemption Approved

Duplicate charge
reported Declined or
cancelled

Clinician
authorised

Try another
payment

Leave with
Finance Not authorised

Still waiting

Try again

All resources held

Something is
unavailable

Slot found

Nothing available

Another cycle to
come

Last cycle of the
course

Charge or
payment affected

No financial
impact

Stop and release
the series

Consultants

Clinical decisions and authorisations Correspondence and requests from other teams

Referral waiting
for clinical review

Review the referral and
record the clinical
decision

Write the clinical decision
to the audit trail

What is the
clinical decision?

Referral accepted Referral accepted

Referral rejected

Referral
redirected

Further clinical
information
requested

Outcome returned
to Medical
Secretaries

Patient attended
the new patient
appointment

Record consent and

complete the treatment
booking request

Has the patient
agreed to
proceed?

Authorise the treatment

booking request
Authorised
treatment booking
request issued

Booking request
issued

Patient declined
treatment at this
time

Declined
- pathway review
ed

Chemotherapy
cycle review
requested

Review blood results and

decide on the next cycle

Record the cycle review
decision

Is the patient fit
to continue?

Continue with the
next cycle

Next cycle
authorised

Delay the next
cycle

Cycle delayed for
clinical reasons

Change the
treatment plan

Treatment change
raised for
authorisation

Treatment change
raised

Authorise the treatment
modification

Is this an urgent
patient-safety
change?

Urgent change
authorised

Treatment change
authorised

Financial impact
to Finance

Change applied

Clinic letter to be
written

Draft and approve the
clinic letter

Flag the letter as
delayed

Letter flagged for
pathway
monitoring

Has the
Consultant
approved the
letter?

Clinic letter
approved

Letter released to
Medical
Secretaries

Record the reminder

against the letter
Reminder
recorded

Letter returned for
clinical correction

Correct and re-approve
the clinic letter

Corrected letter
approved

Corrected letter
released

Urgent treatment
authorisation
requested

Authorise urgent
treatment without

confirmed payment
Urgency decision
returned

Urgent treatment
decision recorded

Clinical review
requested

Pathway review
requested by
another team

Treatment change
forwarded

Provide the clinical
review outcome

Clinical review
outcome

Ask for a follow-
up appointment

Clinical review
closed

Outcome returned
to Medical
Secretaries
- Referral redirec
ted

Outcome returned
to Medical
Secretaries
- Further clinical
information
requested

Change applied
- Financial impact
to Finance

Day 7 Reminder

Accept

Reject

Redirect

Needs more
clinical detail

Consent recorded

Not proceeding

Fit to continue

Delay

Change the plan

Patient safety
- act now

Normal change

Still in progress

Approved

Outpatient Bookings

Team

Appointments Cancellations, declines and enquiries

Referral accepted
- to book

Work out priority,
timeframe and contact
rule

Search the external

scheduling service for
appointments
Did the service
return anything
usable?

Choose and confirm the

appointment

Create the appointment
record

Which contacts
does this patient
need?

Send the appointment
letter

Chase the appointment
letter

Ask for a
telephone call

Contact finished

Patient
notification
complete

New patient
appointment
confirmed

Decide what to do without
a suitable slot

How should the
booking gap be
handled?

Refer the delay
to the pathway
team

Booking gap
escalated

Follow-up
appointment
requested

Look for a follow-up slot

Was a follow-up
slot found?

Confirm the follow-up
appointment

Create the follow-up
appointment

Tell the patient about the
follow-up

Follow-up
appointment
confirmed

Highlight the
follow-up delay

Follow-up delay
with the pathway
team

Cancelled,
declined or not
attended

Record the appointment
outcome

Decide whether another

appointment is offered

What happens
next?

Ask the clinical
team to review
the pathway

Pathway review
requested

Look for a replacement
appointment

Replacement
appointment
offered

Inform the
referring
organisation

Ask Finance
about the
payment taken

Cancellation
handled

Patient declined
treatment

Record the decline and

arrange clinical follow-up
Decline to clinical
team

Decline recorded

Admin enquiry
handed over

Answer the administrative

enquiry
Administrative
enquiry answered

Enquiry answered

Cancellation
handled
- Ask Finance ab
out the payment
taken

Service down Rejected

No slot

No slot

Search wider

Options available

Nothing suitable

Letter always

Within two weeks
- call as well

Escalate

Slot inside the
window

Outside the
clinical window

Offer another date

Clinical review

Close and inform
the referrer

External Scheduling Service

Appointment slot search

Slot search
requested by the
hospital

Search the appointment
slots that match the

request
Return the slots
that are available

Slots returned

Patient or authorised representative

Attendance and contact

Patient attends
the new patient
appointment

Confirm that the
appointment was
attended

Appointment
attended

Clinical Nurse Specialist

Team

Clinical Nurse Specialist

Team
Clinical enquiry
assigned

Urgent clinical
concern assigned

Triage the enquiry and
respond

Does this need a
Consultant?

Ask the
Consultant for a
clinical review

Clinical review
outcome

Record the advice given

Enquiry resolved Enquiry answered
and closed

Escalate the
unanswered
urgent concern

Urgent concern
escalated

1 hour

Needs a
Consultant

Answered directly

Call Handling

Team

Enquiries and outbound contact

Enquiry received
by the call
handling team

Log the enquiry, classify it
and set a priority

What kind of
enquiry is this?

Is this an urgent
clinical concern?

Urgent concern
to CNS

Send the enquiry
to the nurse
specialists

Send the enquiry
to the Finance
Team

Can this be
answered with the
information
available?

Answer the administrative

question

Enquiry to admin
team

Enquiry resolved
by the specialist
team

Close the enquiry record

Enquiry resolved

Short notice call
requested

Contact finished

Contact the patient by
telephone
Patient contacted
- call handling co
mplete

Clinical

Financial

Administrative

Urgent

Routine clinical

Answered on the
call

Needs another
team

Patient Pathway Coordinators

Correspondence monitoring Booking and treatment delays

Weekly
correspondence
review

How far overdue
is the letter?

Drop letters that no
longer need chasing

Send the weekly
reminder to the
Consultant

Reminder issued

Escalate to the
Administrative
Manager

Escalated to the
Administrative
Manager

Escalate beyond
three months

Escalated to
higher
management

Letter flagged as
delayed

Add the letter to pathway
monitoring
Letter added to
the monitoring list

Booking delay
flagged by a team

Treatment
booking still
pending

Follow-up slot
outside the
clinical window

Review the delay and
agree the next step

What does the
delay need?

Ask the clinical
team to
reprioritise

Delay with the
clinical team

Write to the patient about
the delay
Patient informed

Produce the weekly
overdue correspondence
list

Funding delay
flagged by the
booking team

One week to one
month

Over one month

Over three
months

Clinical
reprioritisation

Keep the patient
informed

Administrative Management

Team

Escalations

Overdue letter
escalated to the
manager

Contact the responsible
Consultant

Has the letter
been completed?

Record the
escalation
outcome

Escalation
recorded

Letter
outstanding
beyond three
months

Refer the case to

higher management

Record the higher
level escalation

Higher
management
escalation
recorded

Completed - close
Still outstanding

Check referral pack against the document checklist
- Secretaries check the pack and chase what is missing. They never record a view on whether t
he referral is clinically suitable.

Is the referral pack complete?
- Nothing reaches a clinician without a complete pack, and nothing reaches a patient without an
authorised clinical decision behind it.

Decide whether a refund is due

- Finance decides funding and refunds. Clinical staff may explain a treatment decision but ca
nnot approve money.

Check the request is complete and authorised
- A request without a named authorising clinician is turned away before anything is booked.

What did the provider report?
- Money never leaves the patient's account twice. A repeated attempt gets a new reference, an
d a duplicate report stops the booking.

Release the provisional appointment series
- Compensation. If external capacity never arrives, the provisional series is released instead of
being left held.

What is the clinical decision?

- Accept, reject, redirect or ask for more clinical detail. The reason and the deciding clinician
are recorded and cannot be edited afterwards.

Draft and approve the clinic letter
- The seven day letter target runs from the appointment, not from when drafting starts.

How far overdue is the letter?

- Seven days, one month and three months are the three escalation points for an outstanding cl
inic letter.